

Smart India Hackathon 2026



**SMART INDIA
HACKATHON
2026**

Team ID : ADE19D

Team Name : AgriBridge

Problem Statement ID : SIH26031

Problem statement Title : Quality assessment and grading of onions are often subjective and vary across procurement centers, resulting in disputes and inconsistencies.

Theme : Fitness & Sports

Category : Software

Evaluator Name : Anshul Bhanwalkar

Date of Evaluation : 03 - September - 2026



SIH



THE PROBLEM

Agricultural grading today is **manual**, **inconsistent** and fails to detect **early-stage quality issues**.



Inconsistent & Subjective

Grading varies from person to person, leading to disputes and mistrust.



Early Quality Issues Go Unnoticed

Internal spoilage or defects are not visible but reduce shelf life and market value.



Size & Quality Not Accurate

Manual size estimation and quality checks are imprecise and non-standardized.



No Instant Digital Record

Paper-based records can be lost, tampered with or misused. No real-time traceability.

IMPACT:

Financial losses, farmer exploitation, quality inconsistencies & supply chain inefficiencies.

OUR SOLUTION

A Hybrid AI + IoT System that combines **Gas Sensing** and **Computer Vision** to detect both **Visible defects** and **Early quality issues** — delivering an **Instant, Accurate & Traceable Quality Grade** for any agricultural produce.

HOW IT WORKS

1. Sampling

Take a representative sample (1–2 kg) from the produce batch.



2. Dual Capture

Place sample in the smart sensing pod.



- IoT sensors capture gas emissions, temperature & humidity.
- Camera captures multiple images.

3. AI Analysis (Parallel)

Gas AI (IoT)



Detects early quality risks using gas signatures (Ethylene, VOCs, CO₂, and more) along with environmental data.

Output
Risk Score

Vision AI



Detects visible defects, blemishes, size distribution & foreign materials.

Output
Quality Score

4. Fusion & Decision

(AI Fusion Engine)



Combines both AI outputs with confidence scoring to generate a final Quality Grade aligned with standards.

Grade: A / B / C / D
Score: 87/100

5. Instant Report & Traceability



Digital Report (PDF)



QR Code



Cloud Sync & Secure Storage

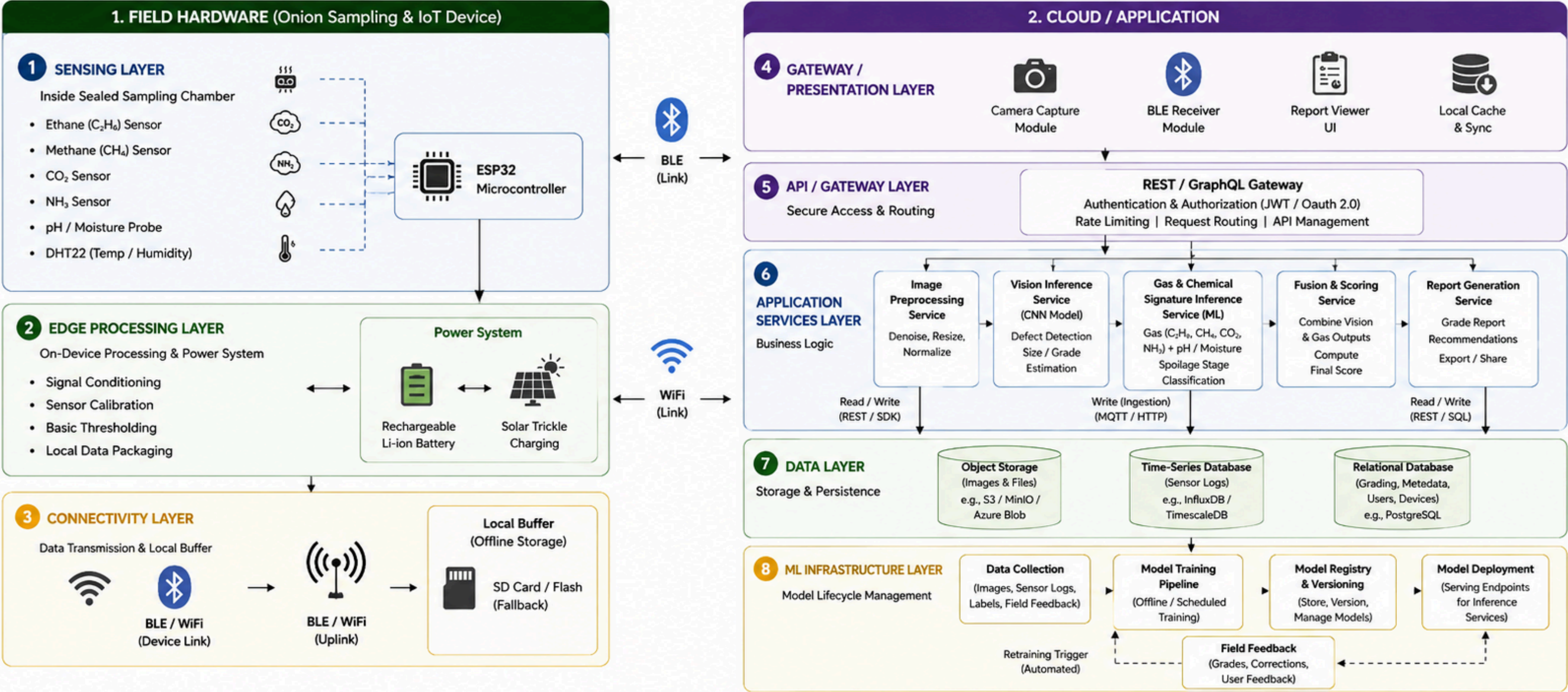
- ✓ Timestamped
- ✓ Geo-tagged
- ✓ Tamper-proof
- ✓ Shareable instantly

Digital Quality Certificate

Batch ID : AG-2026-000782
Date : 03 Sept 2026
Produce : Mixed Produce
Location : Procurement Center
Grade : A
Score : 87/100



Hybrid AI + IoT System for Onion Quality Grading





Practical. Affordable. Scalable.



1. TECHNICAL FEASIBILITY



Low-cost & proven hardware

ESP32, MQ gas sensors, pH, DHT22, camera.



Smartphone as gateway

No extra display or hardware required.



Practical AI models

Vision + gas signature models using lightweight ML.



Scalable infrastructure

Cloud-based with continuous retraining.



2. OPERATIONAL FEASIBILITY



Easy to use

Simple 4-step workflow; minimal training for inspectors.



Reliable connectivity

BLE / Wi-Fi; syncs when internet is available.



Built for field use

Portable, battery/solar powered, rugged for mandi conditions.



Instant digital reports

Timestamped, geo-tagged reports in seconds.



3. FINANCIAL VIABILITY



Low cost per center

₹ 8,000 – ₹ 10,000 per unit



Low operating cost

Minimal maintenance and long sensor life.



High ROI

Faster grading, fewer disputes and better decisions → savings.



Multiple revenue streams

Device sales, SaaS analytics, data insights.



4. DATA FEASIBILITY



Easy data collection

Gas + environmental data and images at mandis.



Ground truth available

Spoilage validated by cut sample inspection.



Data improves over time

More centers = more data = better models.

DATA SOURCES

- Procurement centers
- ICAR-DOGR / Research labs
- Pilot deployments
- User feedback & outcomes



5. LEGAL & REGULATORY FEASIBILITY



AGMARK aligned

Grading logic mapped with AGMARK standards.



Transparent & traceable

QR-based reports ensure auditability.



Data privacy & security

Farmer & transaction data stored securely and used responsibly.



6. SCALABILITY



Designed to scale

Works across multiple crops and procurement centers.



Cloud-based architecture

Supports thousands of devices and users.



Continuous improvement

Models get better with real-world data and feedback loop.



OVERALL VIABILITY

Technically feasible, operationally practical and financially viable.
Deployable at scale with high impact on transparency, efficiency and farmer trust.



Benefits
Farmers



Supports Govt.
Procurement



Improves Trust
& Transparency



Better Quality,
Better Markets

 **BENEFITS OF THE SOLUTION**

	GRADING ACCURACY	Reduces variation between inspectors, applies standardized quality criteria, and provides evidence behind grading decisions.
	SPOILAGE INTELLIGENCE	Combines visible-defect detection with gas signatures, identifies potential early-stage deterioration, and helps distinguish borderline batches.
	PROCUREMENT EFFICIENCY	Reduces dependence on manual visual inspection and inspector variability, supports faster batch-level decisions, and generates digital assessment records automatically.
	TRACEABILITY	Maintains a digital record of each assessment, enables batch-wise quality history, and makes grading decisions easier to verify.
	WASTE REDUCTION	Identifies batches with potential spoilage risk earlier, supports informed storage-duration decisions, and helps reduce avoidable post-harvest losses.

 **POTENTIAL IMPACT ON THE TARGET AUDIENCE**

	FARMERS	Receive an objective and evidence-based grade with digital records, reducing disputes and ensuring fair treatment during procurement.
	PROCUREMENT CENTERS	Same standardized grading workflow across inspectors and locations ensures consistency, reliability and ease of adoption.
	STORAGE & BUYERS	Gas sensor data reveals potential deterioration before visible defects appear, enabling better storage planning and informed buying decisions.
	AGRICULTURAL SUPPLY CHAIN	Digital grading records create a valuable dataset for procurement planning, quality tracking, traceability and policy-level decision making.

Key research supporting our approach to AI + Gas Sensing based onion quality assessment and grading

#	RESEARCH PAPER		KEY CONTRIBUTION	SOURCE
1		Quality assessment of onions using electronic nose — system development and detection	- Developed an electronic nose system for onion quality assessment. - Detected freshness and spoilage using volatile compounds. - Achieved good classification accuracy with sensor array.	ResearchGate
2		Detecting sour skin infected onions using a customized gas sensor array	- Designed a customized gas sensor array to detect sour skin. - Identified specific gas patterns associated with infected onions. - High detection accuracy in real storage conditions.	ScienceDirect
3		Onion sour skin detection using a gas sensor array and SVM	- Used gas sensor array with SVM model for sour skin detection. - Extracted features from sensor responses for classification. - Demonstrated effective and robust detection performance.	Springer
4		IoT-enabled electronic nose system for beef quality monitoring and spoilage detection	- IoT-based e-nose system for real-time quality and spoilage monitoring. - Cloud connectivity for data storage and remote access. - Early detection improved shelf-life and quality control.	PMC
5		Onion spoilage detection using PEDOT coated paper based sensor	- Developed PEDOT coated paper-based sensor for spoilage detection. - Sensitive to onion spoilage-related volatile compounds. - Low-cost, flexible and suitable for practical applications.	ResearchGate
6		Real-time visual inspection system for grading fruits using computer vision and deep learning techniques	- Uses deep learning (e.g., MobileNetV2) for vision-based grading. - High accuracy in automated fruit quality assessment. - Supports real-time, non-destructive inspection.	ScienceDirect

COMPARISON WITH EXISTING SYSTEMS				
Feature	Our solution	Intello Labs	Agrograde	Manual grading
Vision defect detection	✓	✓	✓	✗
Gas or chemical spoilage sensing	✓	✗	✗	✗
Internal early rot detection	✓	✗	✗	✗
Field-deployable mobile app	✓	✓	✗	✗
Instant digital report	✓	✓	✓	✗
AGMARK-aligned grading	✓	✗	✗	✓
Low-cost hardware	✓	✓	✗	✓
Dispute-resistant record	✓	✓	✓	✗
Retraining from field data	✓	✓	✗	✗
Mandi-scale scalability	✓	✓	✓	✓



KEY TAKEAWAY



Research across gas sensors, AI/ML, computer vision and IoT demonstrates the potential to accurately detect early spoilage and automate onion quality grading.



Supported / Available



Not available / Limited



THANK YOU!



FOR YOUR TIME, SUPPORT & PARTICIPATION

Together, let's build a **smarter, greener** and more **connected** future.

SMARTER SOLUTIONS

Innovating for
real-world agri challenges.

CONNECTED FUTURE

AI + IoT + Blockchain
for seamless ecosystems.

TRUST & TRANSPARENCY

Secure, traceable
and reliable systems.

SUSTAINABLE IMPACT

Driving growth for
farmers, buyers & communities.

THANK YOU FOR BEING PART OF THIS JOURNEY!

